ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 46

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Japanese Alphabet

はじめての ひらがな

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 46 Japanese Hiragana Letters with English Phonetics

あ い う え お

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Japanese Alphabet — はじめての ひらがな
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 46

Text copyright © 2026 Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza. All rights reserved.
No part of this book may be reproduced, stored or shared in any form without written permission from the publisher, except that parents and teachers may copy pages for use with their own children or class.

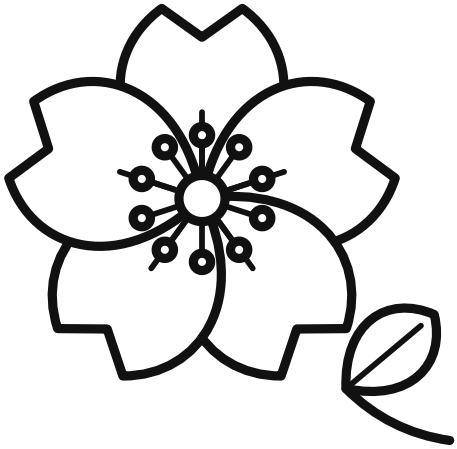
Published by **Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** (مكتبة كنوز الآخرة),
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust, Bangladesh.
Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

First edition, 2026.

Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

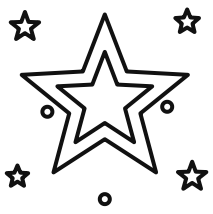
Fonts: M PLUS Rounded 1c, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License.
Map data: Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

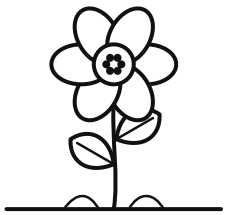


This book belongs to
この ほんの もちぬし

I started learning Japanese on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 46 is Japanese. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- Every hiragana is **one beat**. **Doubled vowels** (aa, ii, uu, oo) are long: hold them for two beats, as in *fuusen* (balloon) and *chikyuu* (the Earth). **ei** sounds like a long 'e'.
- The vowels are short and pure: **a** as in "father", **i** as in "see", **u** as in "moon", **e** as in "bed", **o** as in "go".
- A **doubled consonant** (kk, pp, tt) means a tiny pause before it: *sek-ken*, *rak-kasei*.
- Japanese has **no strong stress**: say every beat evenly. The English letters follow **Hepburn romaji** (shi, chi, tsu, fu).

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Japanese name** written in Japanese (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Fifty-sound chart · katakana* shows the letter in its row of the hiragana chart (the letter in the box is the one on the page), its katakana twin, and the new letter it makes with the two dots ゛ or the circle ゜.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow standard Tokyo Japanese.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Japanese! にほんご

nihongo (in kanji: 日本語) — the Japanese word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **125 million people** speak Japanese.[3]

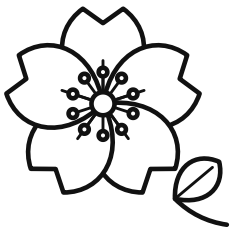
Where?
In **Japan**, a country of thousands of islands in East Asia, and in Japanese families around the world.

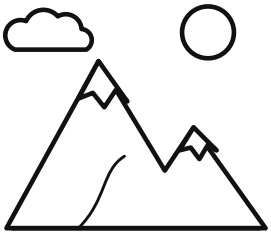
How is it written?
With three scripts together: **hiragana**, **katakana** and **kanji**. Usually left to right, but many books are written from top to bottom.

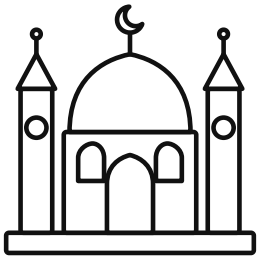
How many letters?
46 basic hiragana. Two little dots ゛ or a circle ゜ make more sounds: か ka → が ga.

Two shapes, one sound
Every hiragana has a **katakana** twin, used for words from other languages: あ ア · か カ · さ サ.

Did you know?
In their first year of school, Japanese children learn **80 kanji**, like 山 (mountain) and 木 (tree).







The Japanese Alphabet ごじゅうおん

5 vowels – あいうえお

あ *a*	い *i*	う *u*	え *e*	お *o*

15 letters of the K, S and T rows – か・さ・た

か *ka*	き *ki*	く *ku*	け *ke*	こ *ko*
さ *sa*	し *shi*	す *su*	せ *se*	そ *so*
た *ta*	ち *chi*	つ *tsu*	て *te*	と *to*

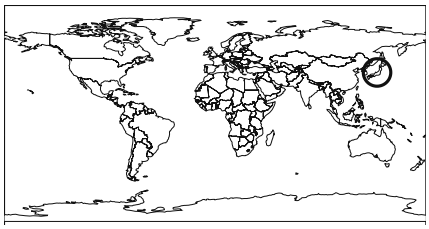
15 letters of the N, H and M rows – な・は・ま

な *na*	に *ni*	ぬ *nu*	ね *ne*	の *no*
は *ha*	ひ *hi*	ふ *fu*	へ *he*	ほ *ho*
ま *ma*	み *mi*	む *mu*	め *me*	も *mo*

11 letters of the Y, R and W rows, and ん – や・ら・わ・ん

や *ya*	ゆ *yu*	よ *yo*	ら *ra*	り *ri*	る *ru*	れ *re*	ろ *ro*	わ *wa*	を *o*	ん *n*

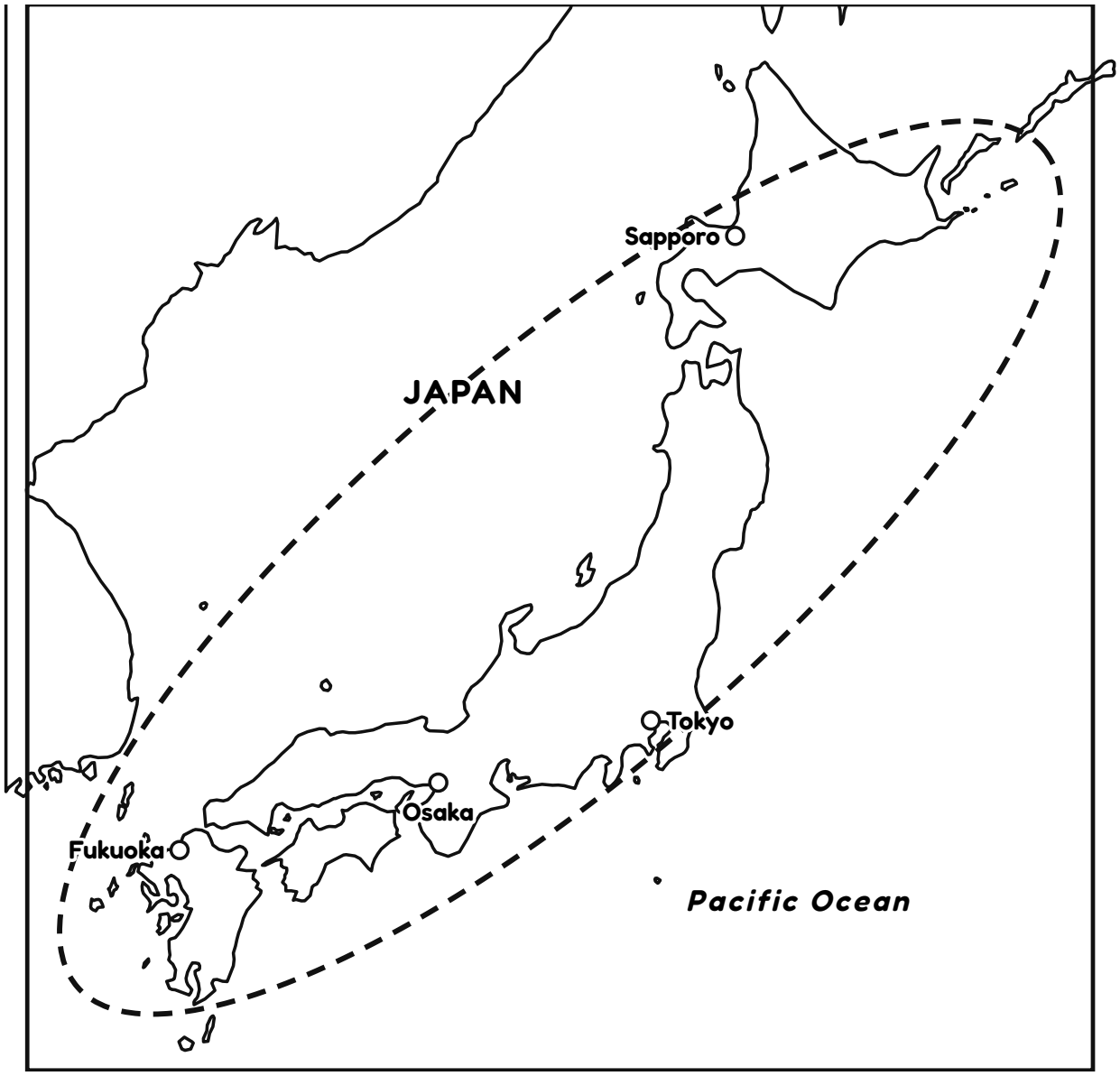
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Japan on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Japanese spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Japanese is spoken all over Japan: in Tokyo, Osaka, Sapporo and Fukuoka, on the four big islands and on many small ones, down to Okinawa in the south.

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

The Vowels あいうえお

a i u e o — the five vowels

Japanese is written with **three kinds of letters** that work together in the same sentence.

Hiragana ひらがな
Round, flowing letters. Each one is a whole sound, one beat: か is *ka*, き is *ki*. There are **46 basic hiragana**, and children learn them first. This book teaches all 46.

Katakana カタカナ
A twin set of sharper letters with the same sounds, used for words from other languages: *I* パン *pan*, bread. Every page shows the katakana twin: あ ア.

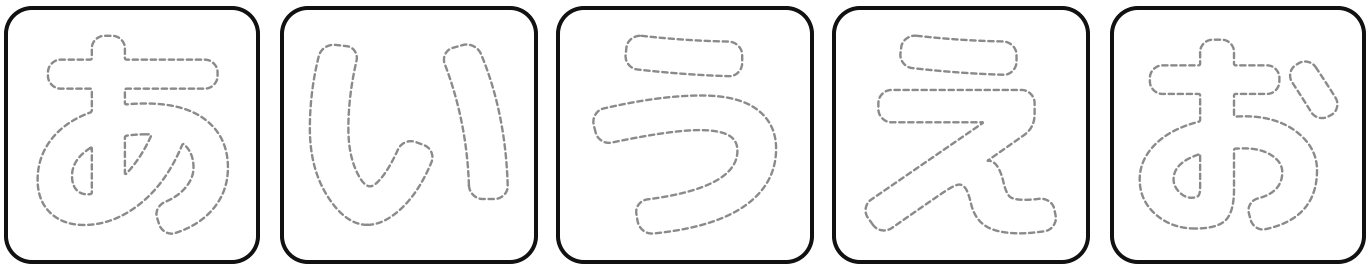
Kanji 漢字
Characters that came from Chinese. Each one stands for a word or idea: 山 *yama*, mountain · 木 *ki*, tree · 日 *hi*, sun. Children learn them little by little at school.

The fifty-sound chart ごじゅうおん
The five vowels あ い う え お make the first row. Every other row adds one consonant to them: か き く け こ is *ka ki ku ke ko*. This book follows the chart, row by row.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowels あいうえお

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



あ

NAME · なまえ

あ

a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'a' as in "father"

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

あ い う え お

Katakana twin: ア



あ IS FOR

あめ

ame

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

あ あ あ あ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

い

NAME · なまえ

い

i

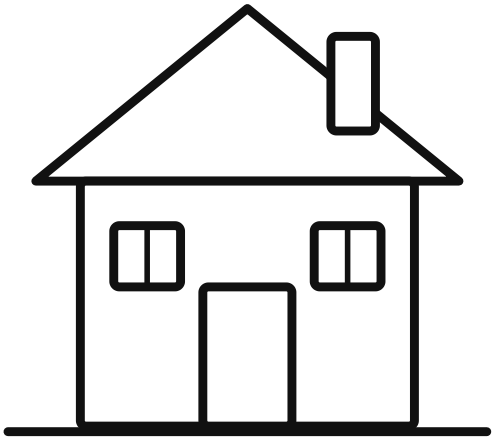
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ee' as in "see", short

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

あ [い] う え お

Katakana twin: イ



い IS FOR

いえ

ie

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

い い い い い

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

う

NAME · なまえ

う

u

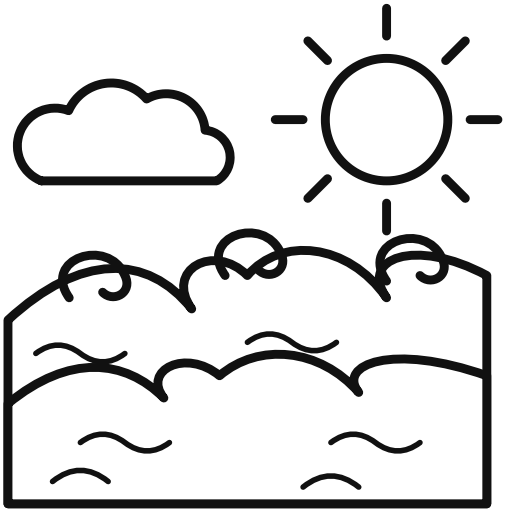
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'oo' as in "moon", short, with relaxed lips

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

あ い **[う]** え お

Katakana twin: ウ



う IS FOR

うみ

umi

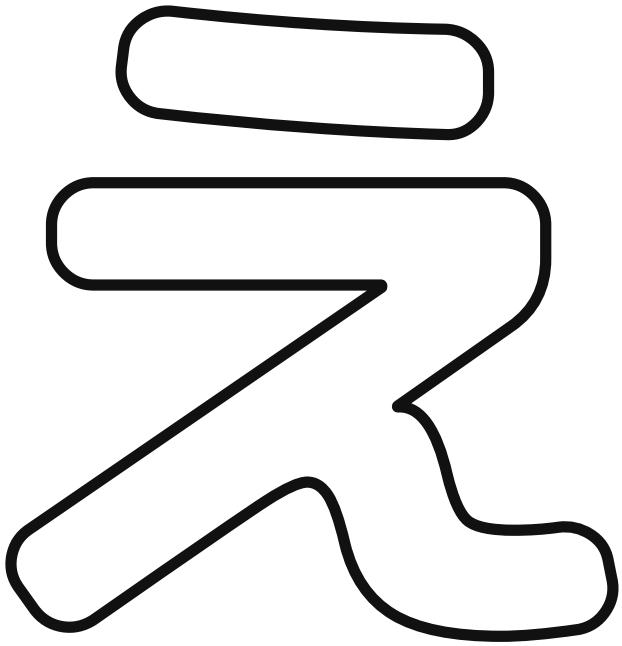
sea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

う う う う

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

え

e

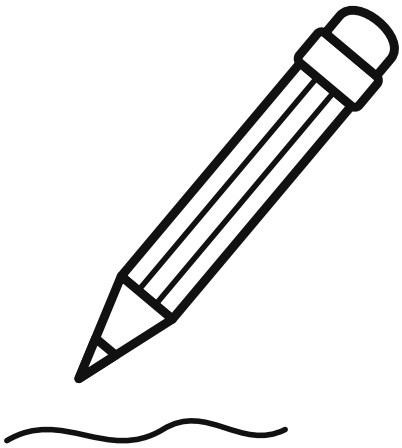
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'e' as in "bed"

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

あ い う **え** お

Katakana twin: エ



え IS FOR

えんぴつ

enpitsu

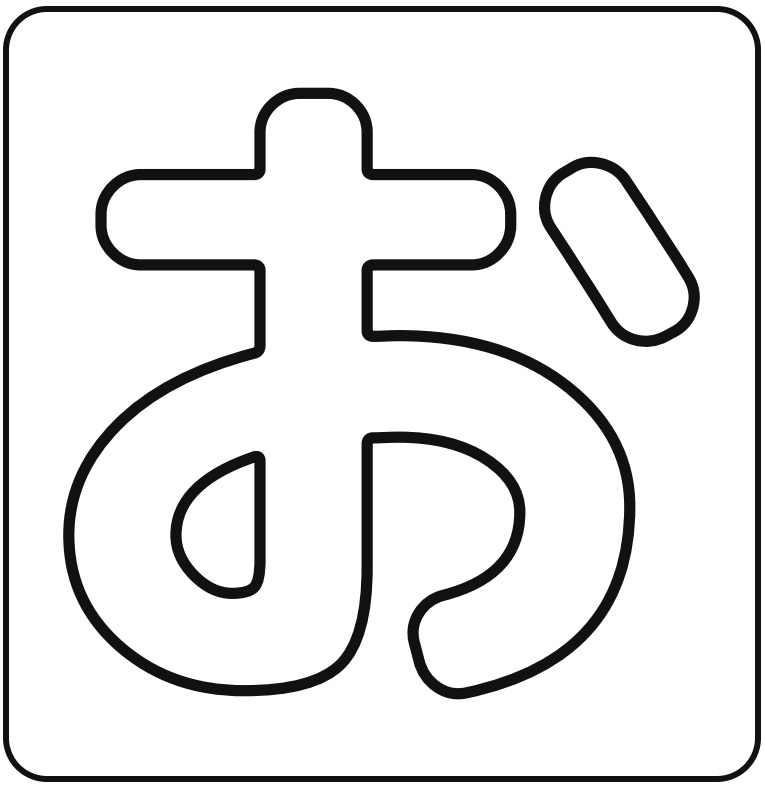
pencil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

え え え え

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

お

o

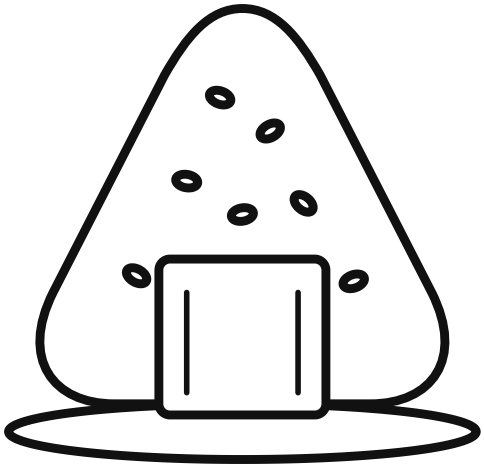
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'o' as in "go", short and round

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

あ い う え お

Katakana twin: オ



お IS FOR

おにぎり

onigiri

rice ball

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

お お お お

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ROWS K · S · T

The K, S and T Rows か・さ・た

ka, sa, ta

Each row joins one consonant to the five vowels: **K** + a, i, u, e, o = か き く け こ.

Watch out for three letters
Three letters do not follow the pattern: し is *shi*, ち is *chi* and つ is *tsu*.

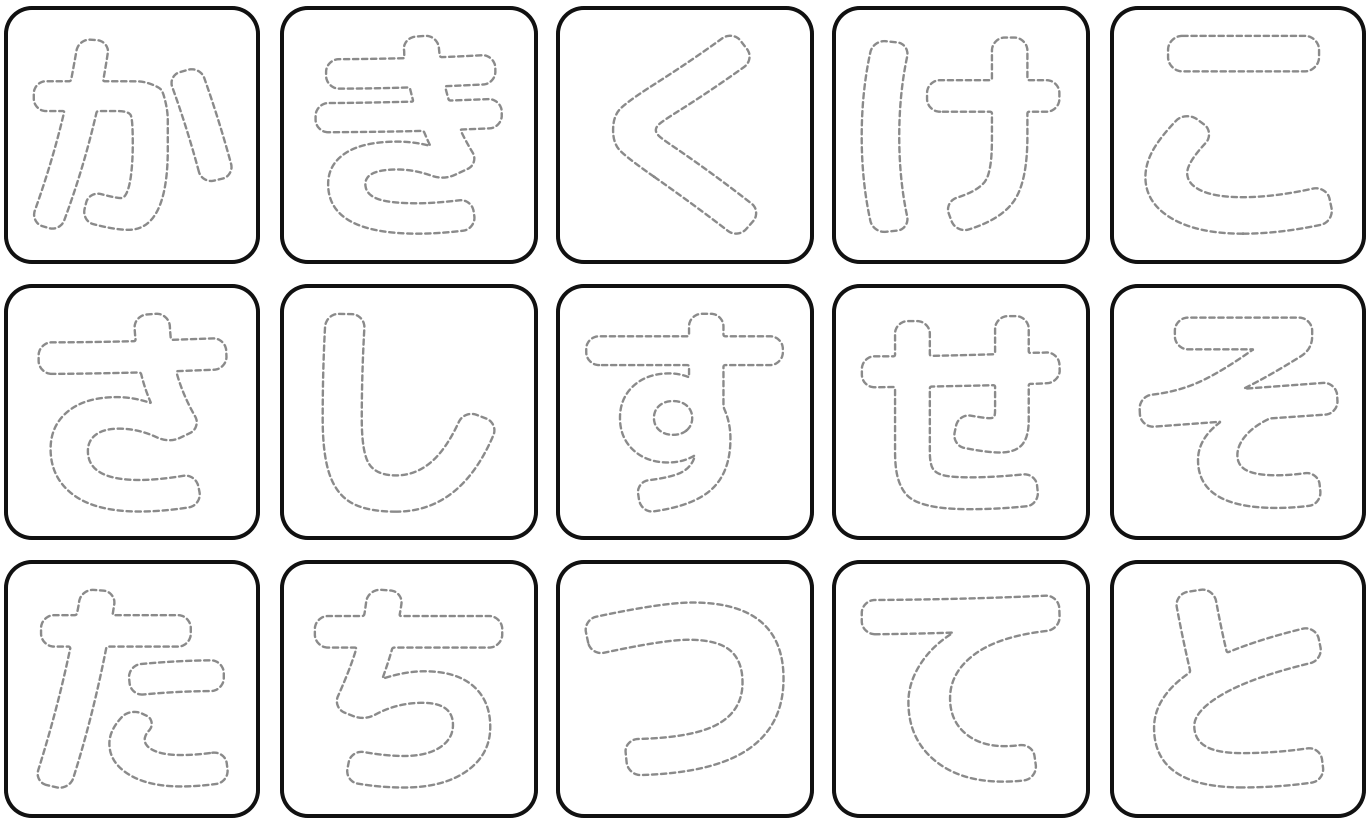
Two little dots ゛
Two dots at the top right make the sound buzzy: か → が (*ga*), さ → ざ (*za*), た → だ (*da*).

A small っ
A small っ means “hold for a beat”: せっけん is *sek-ken*, soap.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the K, S and T rows か・さ・た

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



か

NAME · なまえ

か

ka

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'kah'

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

か き く け こ

Katakana twin: カ · with ゛ : が *ga*



か IS FOR

かさ

kasa

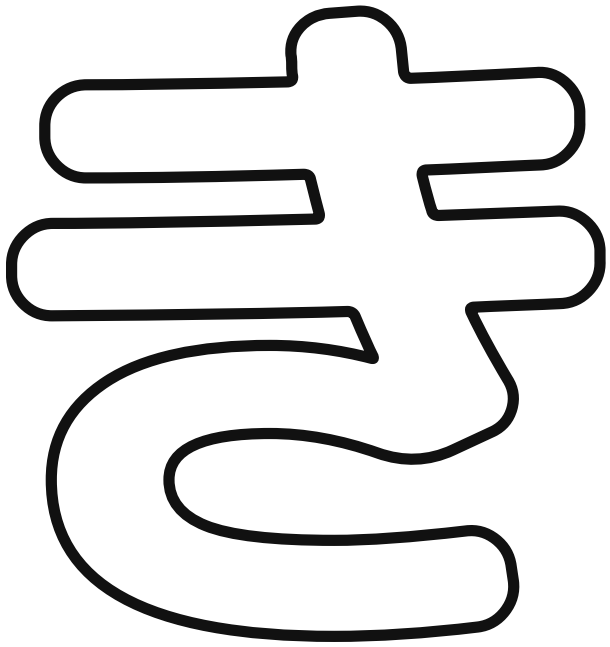
umbrella

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

か か か か

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

き

ki

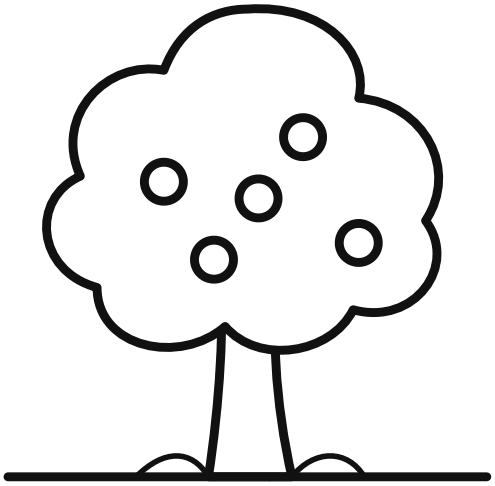
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'kee' as in "key"

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

か **き** く け こ

Katakana twin: キ · with ゛ : ぎ *gi*



き IS FOR

き

ki

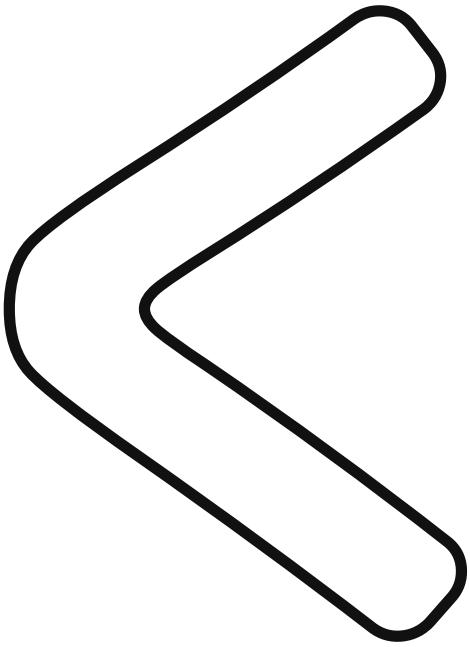
tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

き き き き

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

く

ku

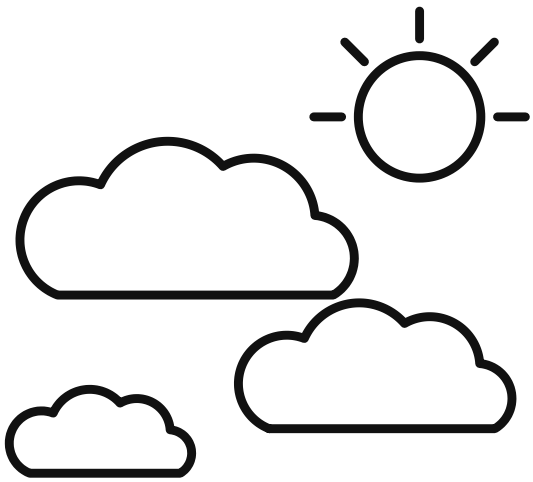
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘koo’ as in “cool”

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

か き **く** け こ

Katakana twin: ク · with ゛ : ぐ *gu*



く IS FOR

くも

kumo

cloud

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

け

NAME · なまえ

け

ke

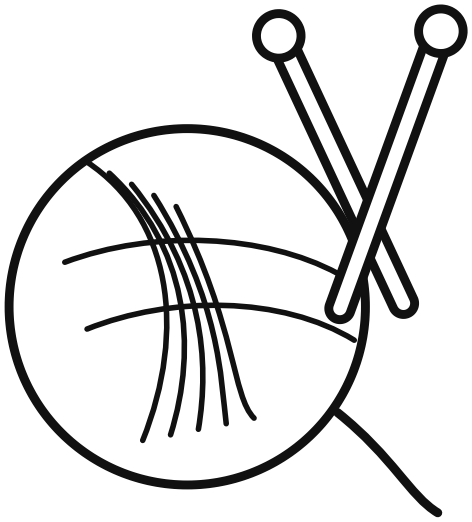
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ke’ as in “kettle”

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

か き く **け** こ

Katakana twin: ケ · with ゛ : げ *ge*



け IS FOR

けいと

keito

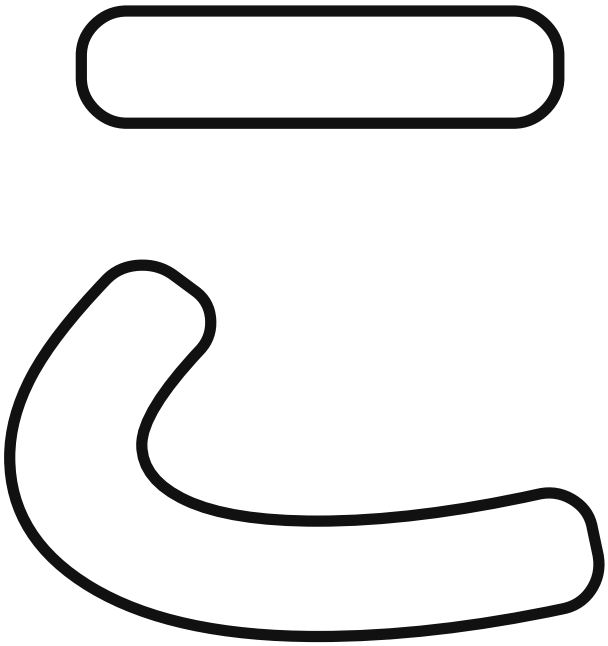
knitting wool

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

け け け け

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

こ

ko

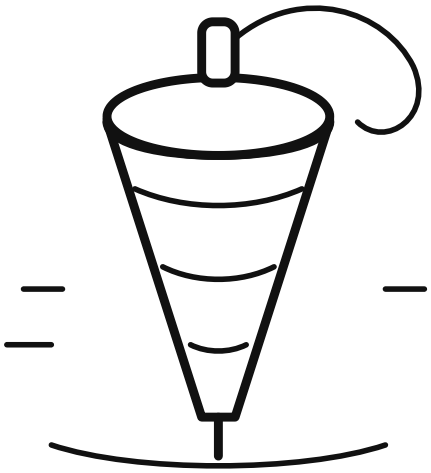
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ko’ as in “coat”, short

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

か き く け こ

Katakana twin: コ · with ゛ : ご *go*



こ IS FOR

こま

koma

spinning top

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

さ

NAME · なまえ

さ

sa

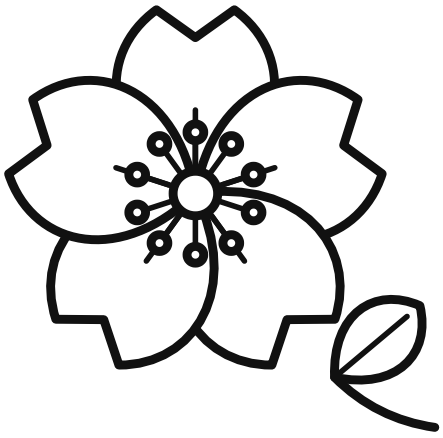
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'sah'

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

さ し す せ そ

Katakana twin: サ · with ゛ : ざ *za*



さ IS FOR

さくら

sakura

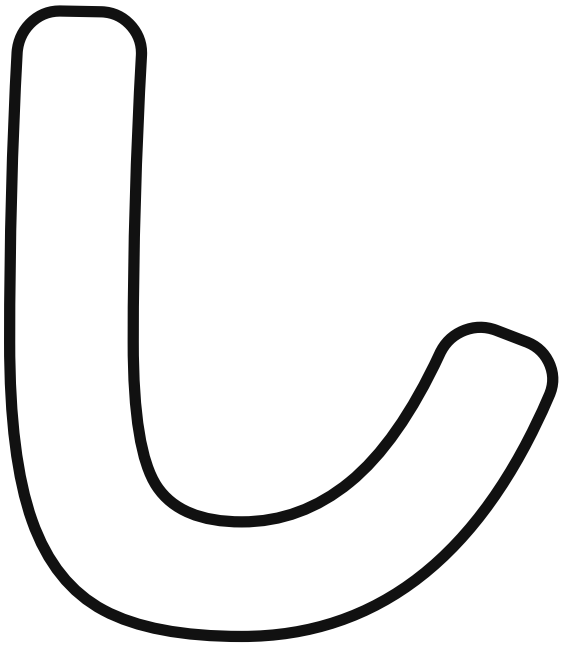
cherry blossom

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

さ さ さ さ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

し

shi

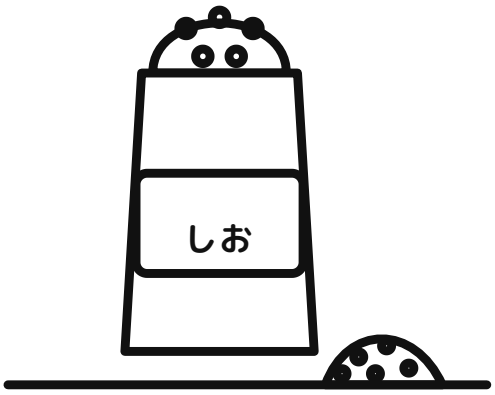
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'shee' as in "sheep", not "see"!

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

さ **[し]** す せ そ

Katakana twin: シ · with ゛ : じ *ji*



し IS FOR

しお

shio

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

し し し し

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

す

NAME · なまえ

す

su

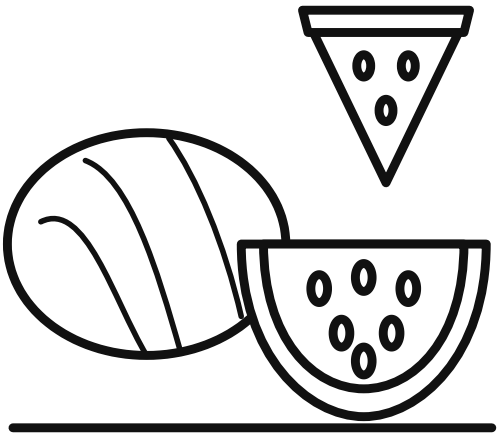
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘soo’, often said very softly

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

さ し **す** せ そ

Katakana twin: ス · with ゛ : ず *zu*



す IS FOR

すいか

suika

watermelon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

す す す す

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

せ

NAME · なまえ

せ

se

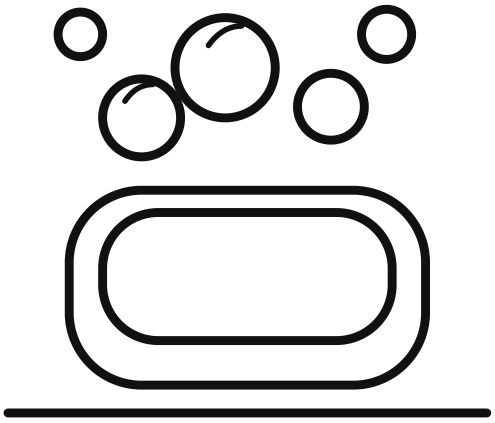
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'se' as in "set"

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

さ し す **せ** そ

Katakana twin: セ · with ゛ : ぜ *ze*



せ IS FOR

せっけん

sekken

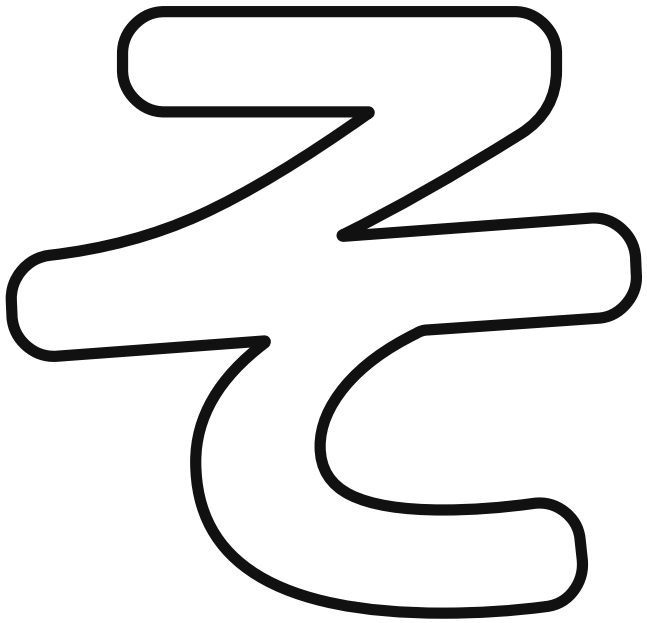
soap

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

せ せ せ せ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

そ

so

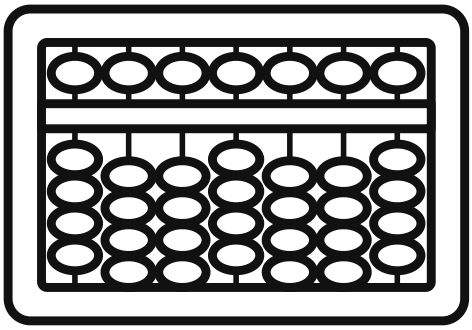
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'so' as in "soap", short

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

さ し す せ **そ**

Katakana twin: ソ · with ゛ : ぞ *zo*



そ IS FOR

そろばん

soroban

abacus (a counting frame)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

そ そ そ そ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

た

NAME · なまえ

た

ta

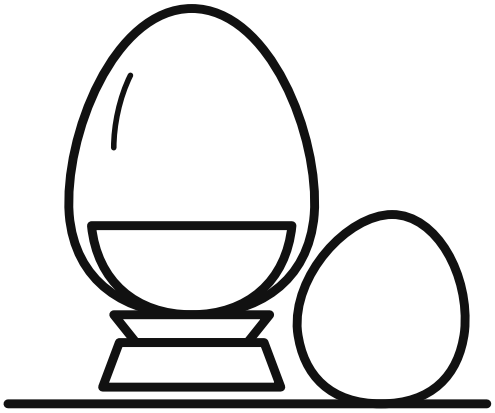
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'tah'

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

た	ち	つ	て	と

Katakana twin: タ · with ゛ : だ *da*



た IS FOR

たまご

tamago

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

た た た た

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ち

NAME · なまえ

ち

chi

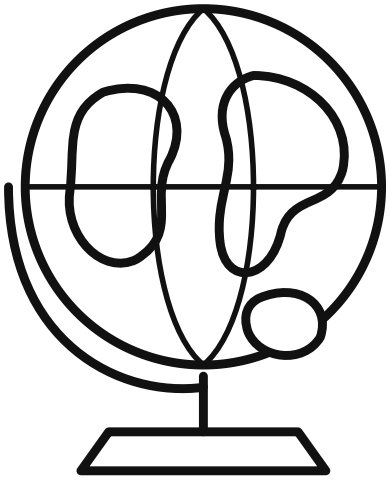
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘chee’ as in “cheese”

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

た **ち** つ て と

Katakana twin: チ · with ゛ : ぢ *ji*



ち IS FOR

ちきゅう

chikyuu

the Earth

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ち ち ち ち

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

つ

NAME · なまえ

つ

tsu

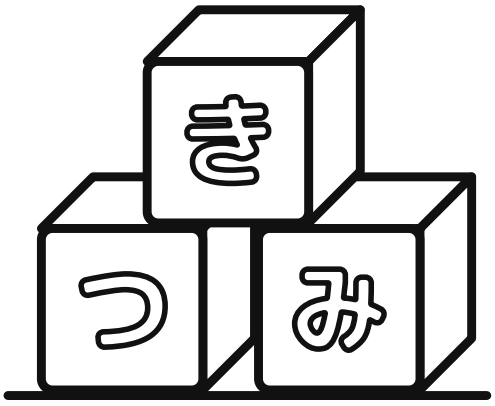
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ts' as at the end of "cats", then 'oo'

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

た ち つ て と

Katakana twin: ツ · with ゛ : づ *zu*



つ IS FOR

つみき

tsumiki

building blocks

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

つ つ つ つ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

て

NAME · なまえ

て

te

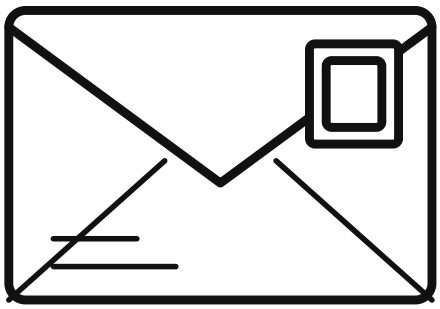
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'te' as in "ten"

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

た ち つ **[て]** と

Katakana twin: テ · with ゛ : で *de*



て IS FOR

てがみ

tegami

letter (to post)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

て て て て

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

と

NAME · なまえ

と

to

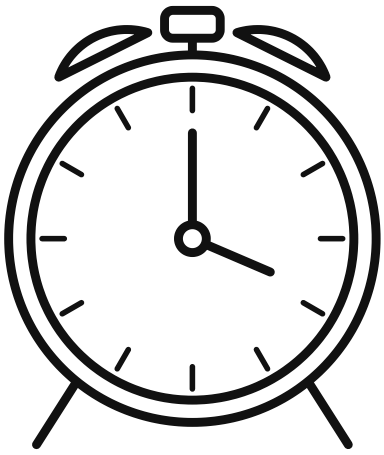
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'to' as in "toe", short

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

た ち つ て **と**

Katakana twin: ト · with ゛ : ど *do*



と IS FOR

とけい

tokei

clock

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

と と と と

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ROWS N · H · M

The N, H and M Rows な・は・ま

na, *ha*, *ma*

Three more rows: **N**, **H** and **M**.

A soft f
ふ is *fu*: blow gently through your lips, as if cooling a hot drink.

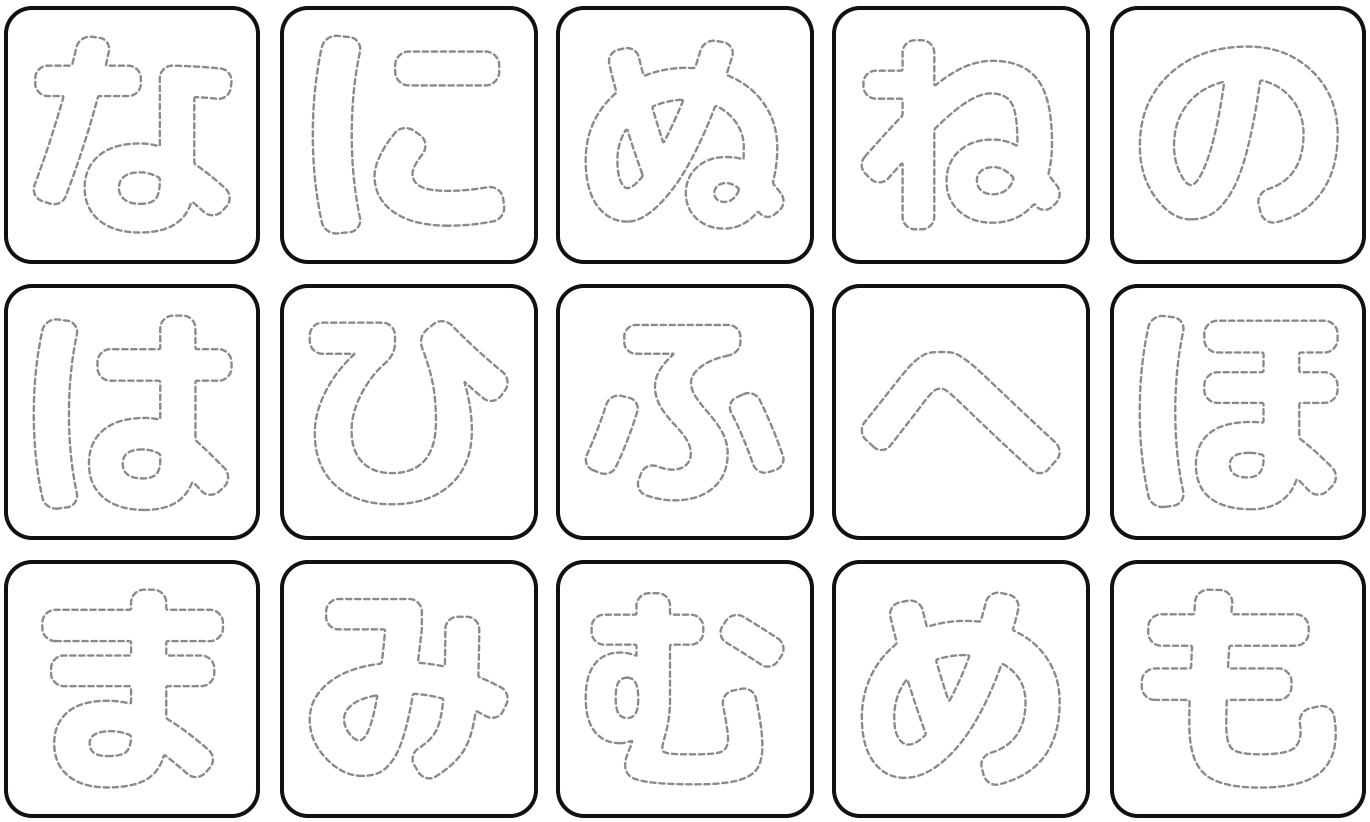
Dots and a circle
The H row can wear two dots or a little circle: は → ば (*ba*), は → ぱ (*pa*).

Look closely
Some letters are cousins: ぬ and め differ only by a little loop, and so do ね and れ. Trace them slowly!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the N, H and M rows な・は・ま

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



な

NAME · なまえ

な

na

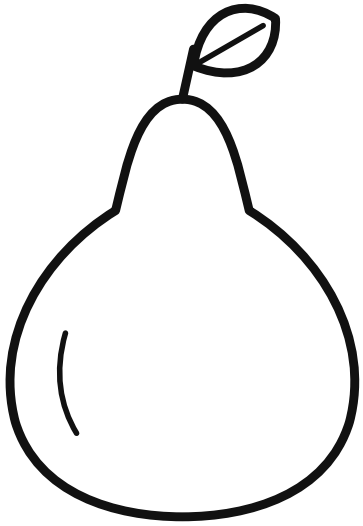
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'nah'

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

[な] に ぬ ね の

Katakana twin: ナ



な IS FOR

なし

nashi

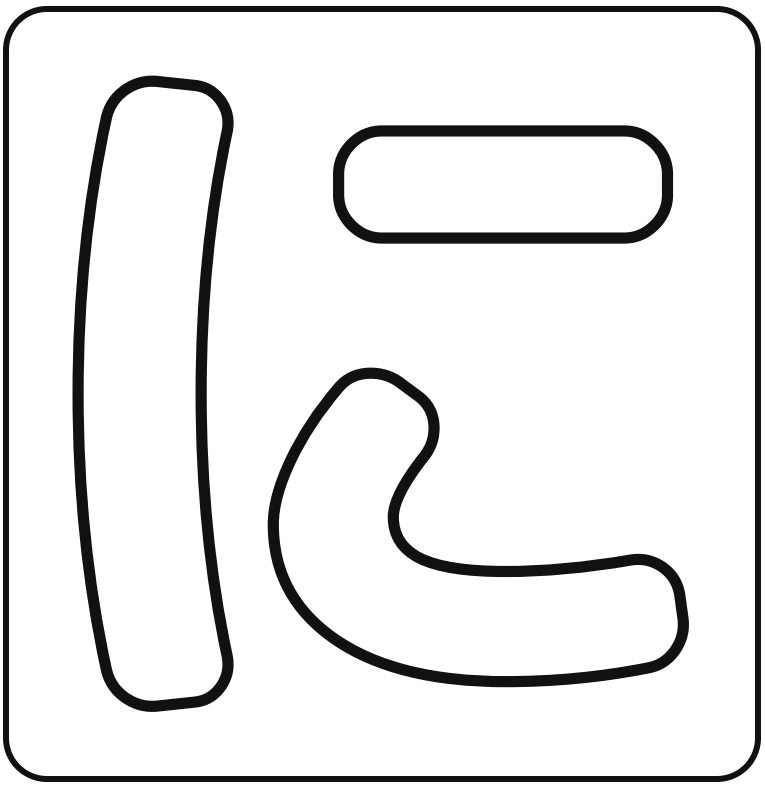
pear

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

な な な な

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

に

ni

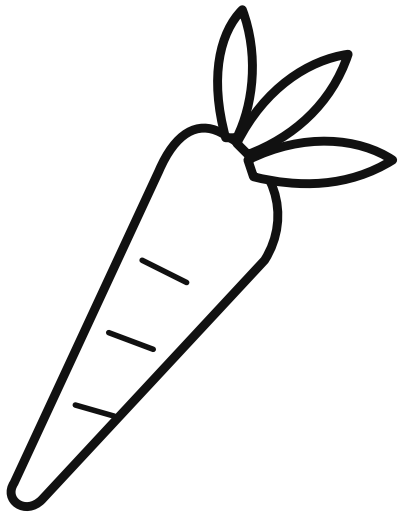
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘nee’ as in “knee”

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

な **に** ぬ ね の

Katakana twin: ニ



に IS FOR

にんじん

ninjin

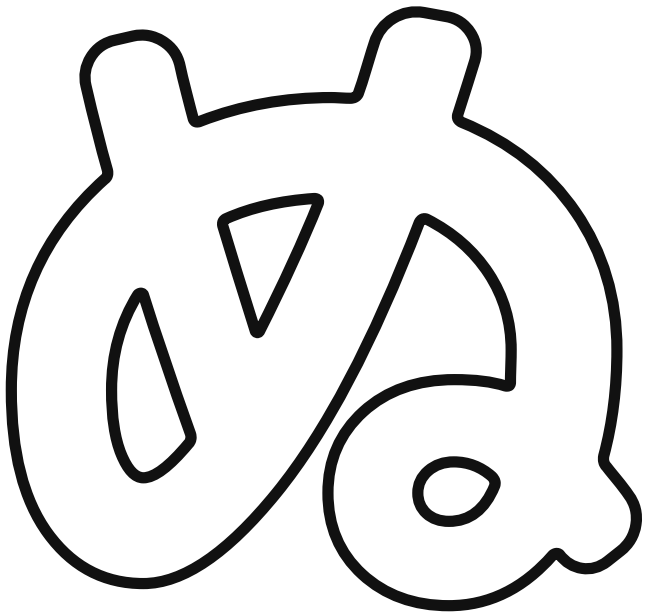
carrot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

に に に に

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

ぬ

nu

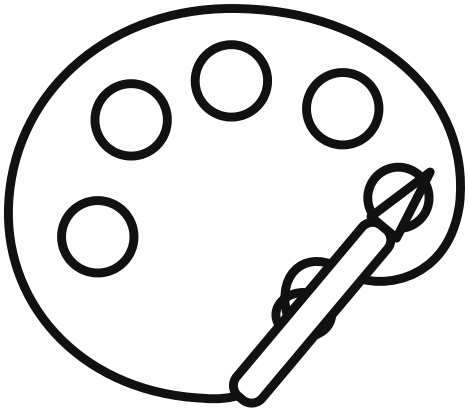
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘noo’ as in “noodle”

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

な に **ぬ** ね の

Katakana twin: ヌ



ぬ IS FOR

ぬりえ

nurie

coloring picture

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ぬ ぬ ぬ ぬ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ね

NAME · なまえ

ね

ne

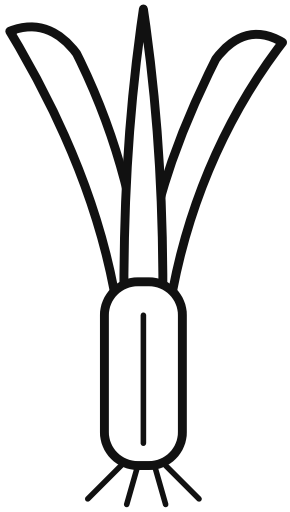
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ne' as in "net"

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

な に ぬ [ね] の

Katakana twin: ネ



ね IS FOR

ねぎ

negi

green onion

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ね ね ね ね

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

の

NAME · なまえ

の

no

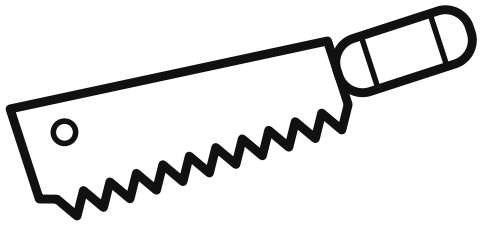
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘no’ as in “note”, short

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

な に ぬ ね **の**

Katakana twin: ノ



の IS FOR

のこぎり

nokogiri

saw

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

の の の の

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

は

NAME · なまえ

は

ha

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

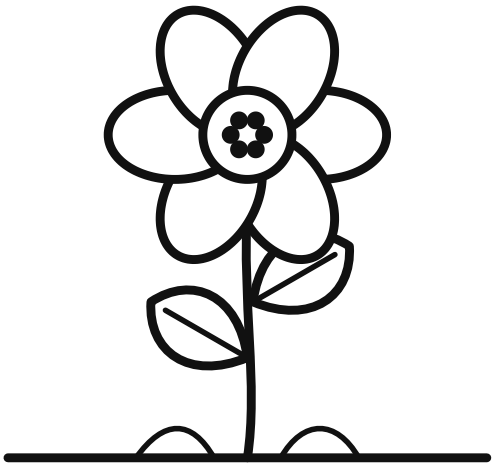
'hah'; as the little word "wa" it says 'wa'

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

は ひ ふ へ ほ

Katakana twin: ハ · with ゛ : ば *ba* · with ゜ : ぱ *pa*

In こんにちは (hello) the last は is read 'wa'.



は IS FOR

はな

hana

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

は は は は

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ひ

NAME · なまえ

ひ

hi

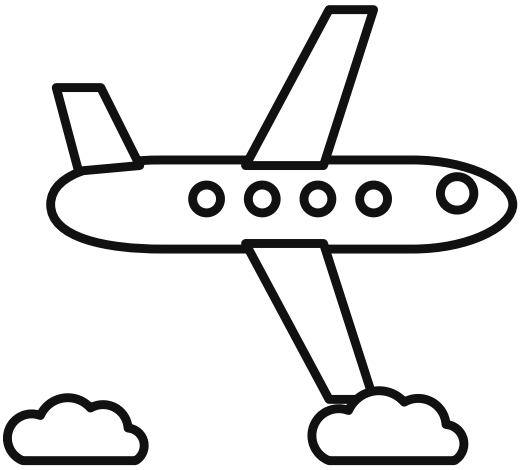
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'hee' as in "heel"

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

は **ひ** ふ へ ほ

Katakana twin: ヒ · with ゛ : び *bi* · with ゜ : ぴ *pi*



ひ IS FOR

ひこうき

hikooki

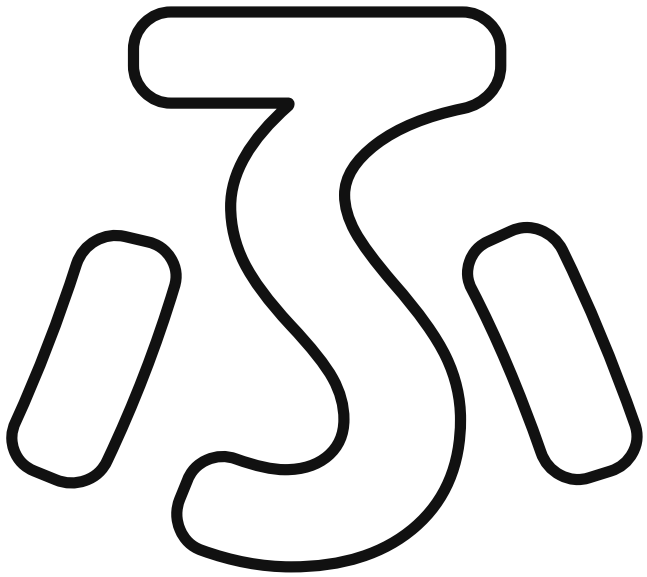
airplane

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ひ ひ ひ ひ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

ふ

fu

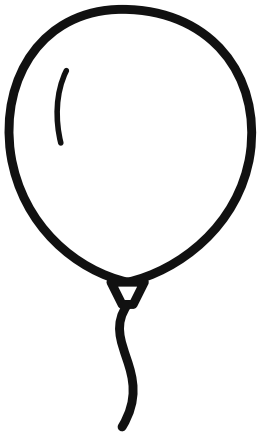
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘f’ blown between the lips, half-way to ‘hoo’

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

は ひ **ふ** へ ほ

Katakana twin: フ · with ゛ : ぶ *bu* · with ゜ : ぷ *pu*



ふ IS FOR

ふうせん

fuusen

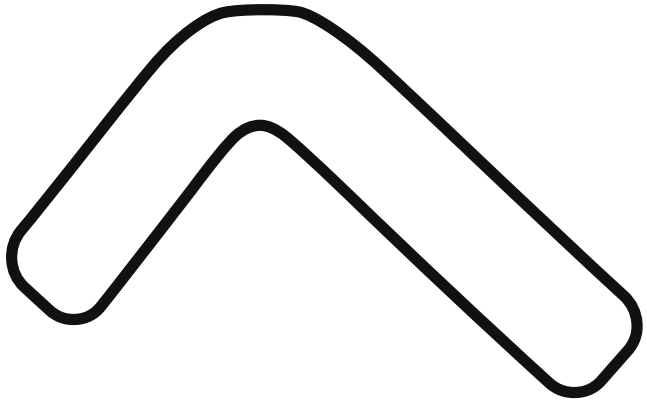
balloon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ふ ふ ふ ふ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

へ

he

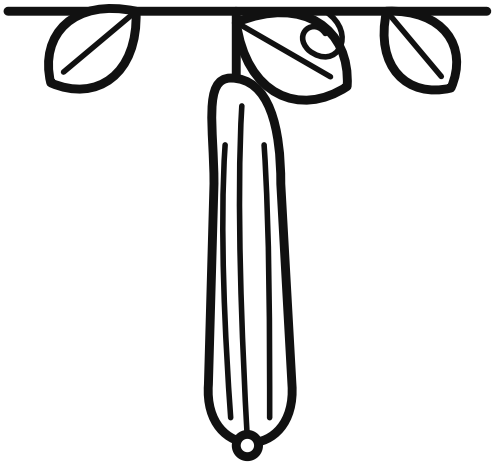
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'he' as in "hen"; as the little word "e" (to) it says 'e'

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

は ひ ふ **へ** ほ

Katakana twin: ヘ · with ゛ : べ *be* · with ゜ : ぺ *pe*



へ IS FOR

へちま

hechima

loofah gourd

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

へ へ へ へ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ほ

NAME · なまえ

ほ

ho

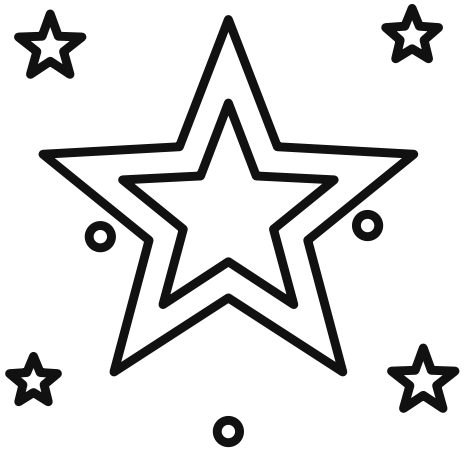
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ho' as in "hope", short

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

は ひ ふ へ [ほ]

Katakana twin: ホ · with ゛ : ぼ *bo* · with ゜ : ぽ *po*



ほ IS FOR

ほし

hoshi

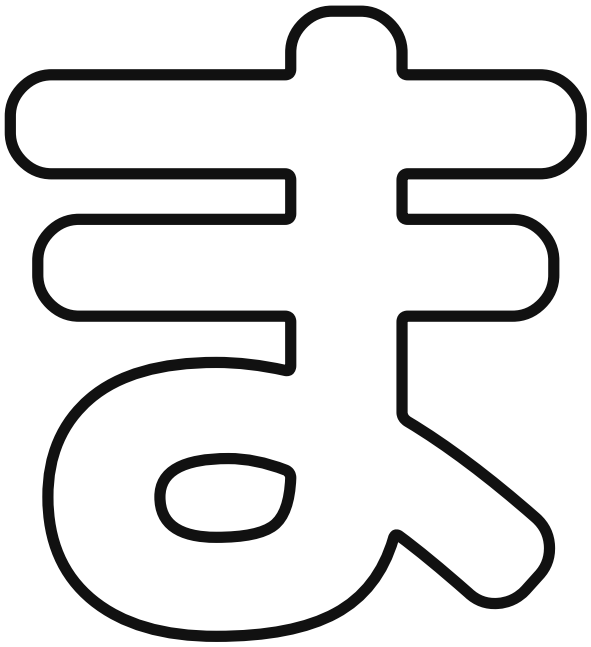
star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ほ ほ ほ ほ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

ま

ma

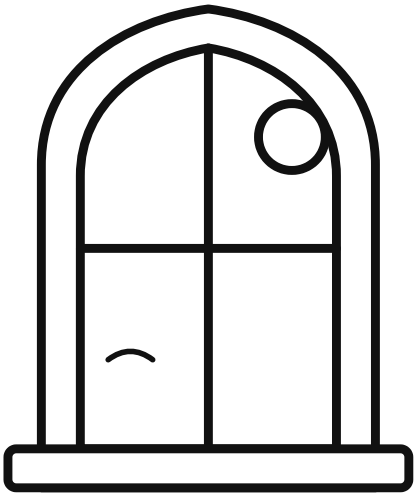
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'mah'

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ま み む め も

Katakana twin: マ



ま IS FOR

まど

mado

window

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ま ま ま ま

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

み

NAME · なまえ

み

mi

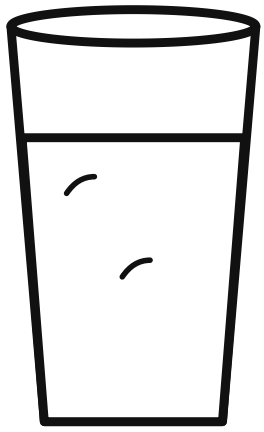
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘mee’ as in “meet”

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ま **み** む め も

Katakana twin: 三



み IS FOR

みず

mizu

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

み み み み

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

む

NAME · なまえ

む

mu

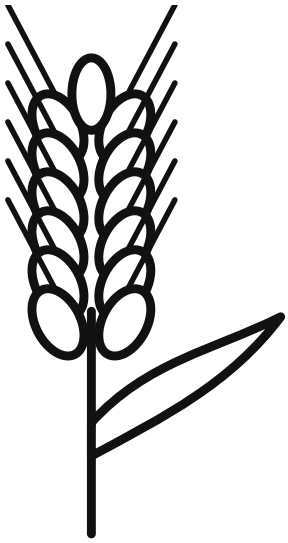
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘moo’

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ま み **む** め も

Katakana twin: ム



む IS FOR

むぎ

mugi

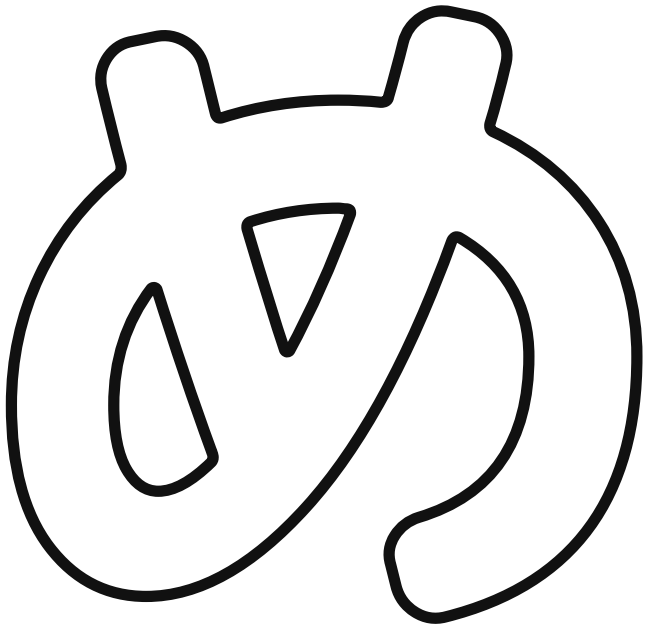
wheat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

む む む む

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

め

me

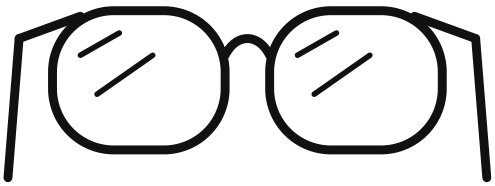
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘me’ as in “met”

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ま み む **め** も

Katakana twin: メ



め IS FOR

めがね

megane

glasses

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

め め め め

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

も

NAME · なまえ

も

mo

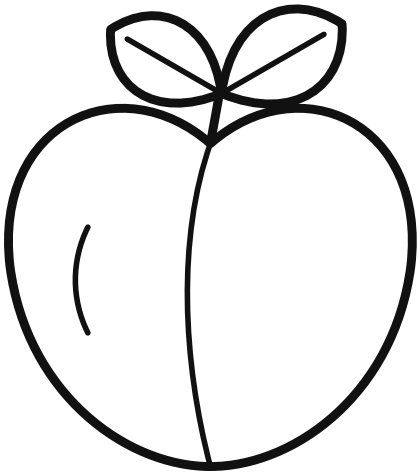
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘mo’ as in “more”, short

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ま み む め **も**

Katakana twin: モ



も IS FOR

もも

momo

peach

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

も も も も

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ROWS Y · R · W · N

The Last Rows や・ら・わ・ん

ya, *ra*, *wa*, *n*

The last rows: **Y**, **R** and **W**, and the letter ん.

Only three in the Y row
や ゆ よ — and their small forms join other letters: き + ゃ = きゃ (*kya*).

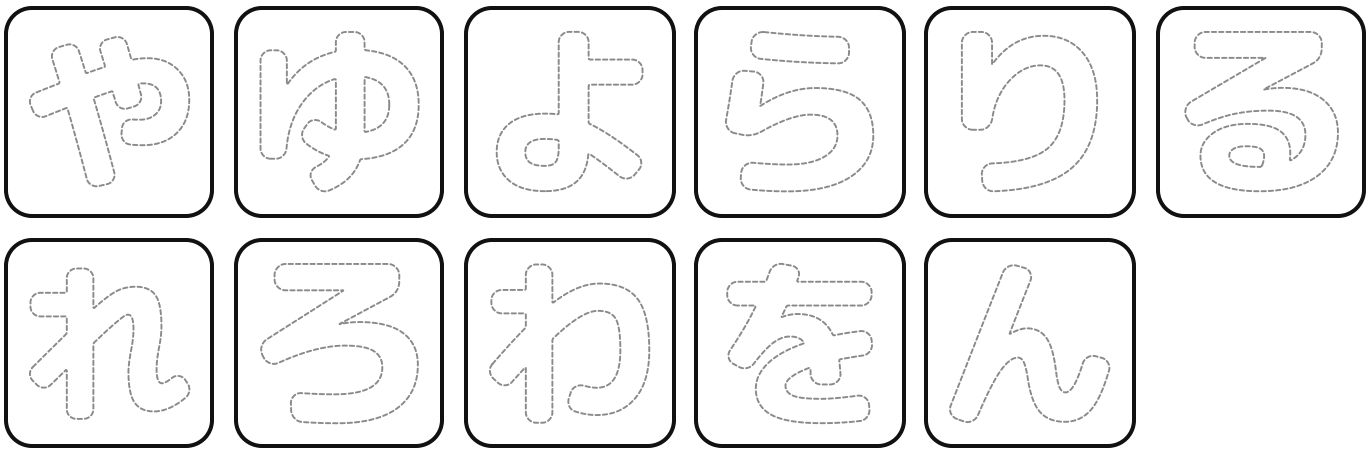
A tapped R
Japanese *r* is a quick tap of the tongue behind the top teeth, somewhere between English r, l and d.

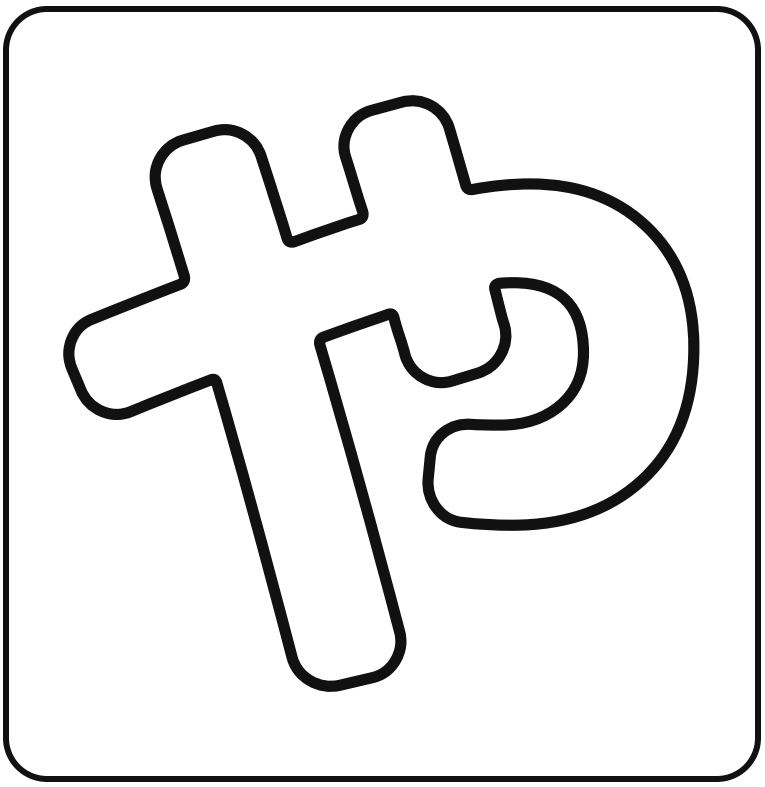
Two special letters
を sounds like お but is only used as a little word in a sentence, and ん is the only letter that is a sound all by itself, without a vowel.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the last rows や・ら・わ・ん

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · なまえ

や

ya

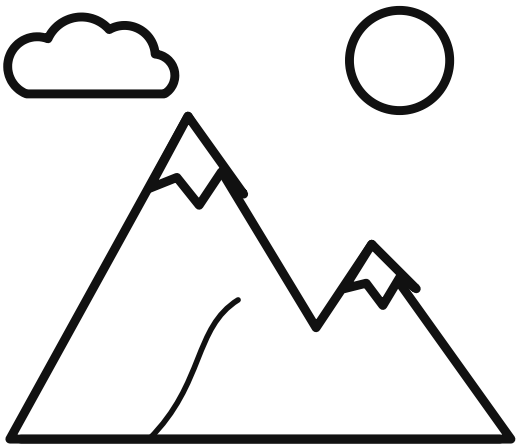
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ya' as in "yard"

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

や ゆ よ

Katakana twin: ヤ



や IS FOR

やま

yama

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

や や や や

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ゆ

NAME · なまえ

ゆ

yu

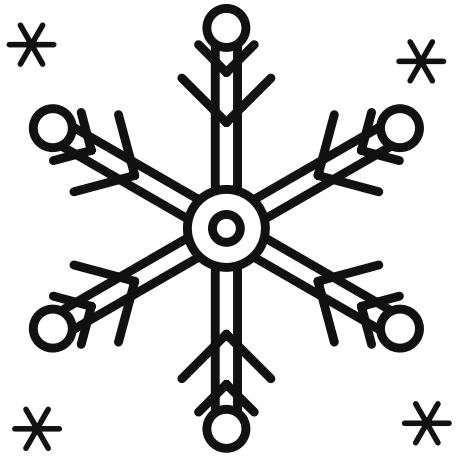
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘you’

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

や **ゆ** よ

Katakana twin: ユ



ゆ IS FOR

ゆき

yuki

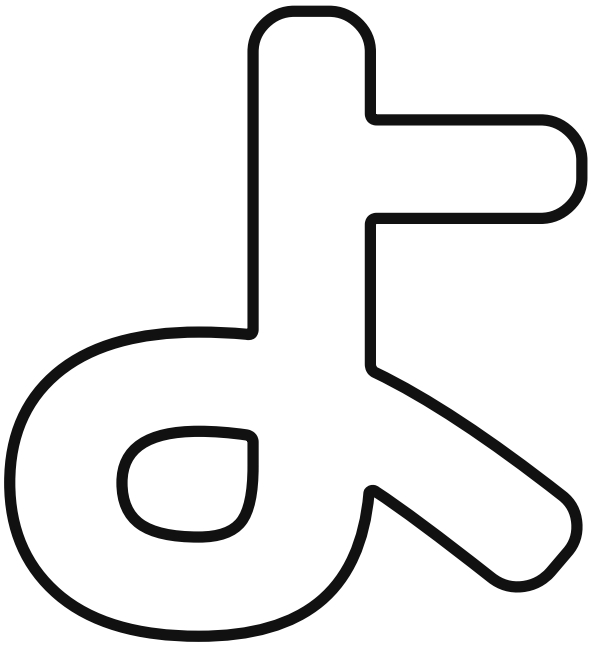
snow

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ゆ ゆ ゆ ゆ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

よ

yo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘yo’ as in “yoga”

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

や ゆ **よ**

Katakana twin: ヨ



よ IS FOR

よる

yoru

night

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

よ よ よ よ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ら

NAME · なまえ

ら

ra

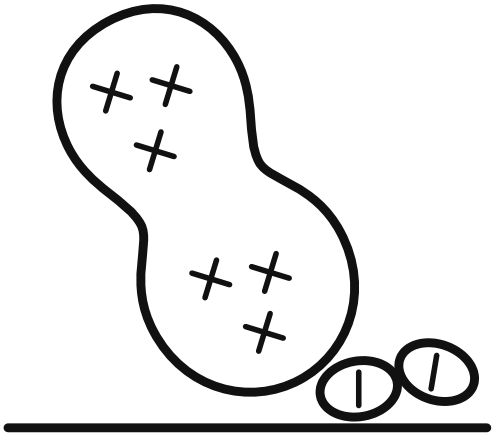
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ra’ with a light tap of the tongue, half-way between r, l and d

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ら り る れ ろ

Katakana twin: ラ



ら IS FOR

らっかせい

rakkasei

peanuts

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ら ら ら ら

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

り

NAME · なまえ

り

ri

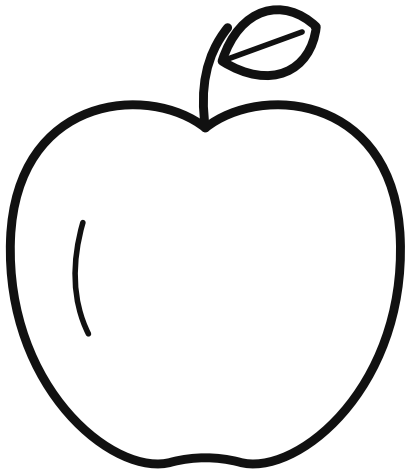
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ree', with a light tap

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ら **り** る れ ろ

Katakana twin: リ



り IS FOR

りんご

ringo

apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

り り り り

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

る

NAME · なまえ

る

ru

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

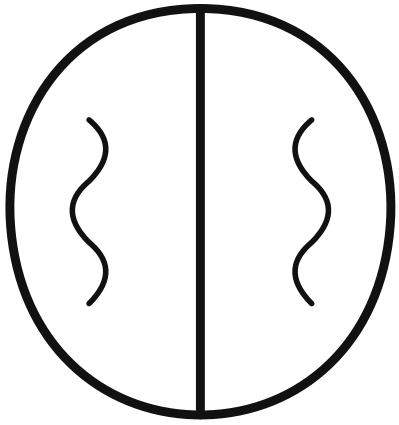
'roo', with a light tap

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ら り **る** れ ろ

Katakana twin: ル

Few words start with る. Find it in the middle of くるみ!



る IS FOR

くるみ

kurumi

walnut

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

る る る る

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

れ

NAME · なまえ

れ

re

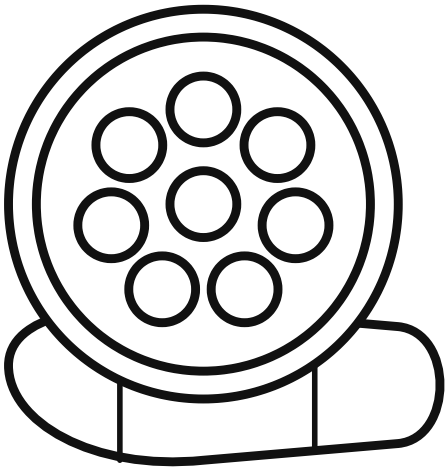
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

're' as in "red", with a light tap

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ら り る れ ろ

Katakana twin: レ



れ IS FOR

れんこん

renkon

lotus root

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

れ れ れ れ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ろ

NAME · なまえ

ろ

ro

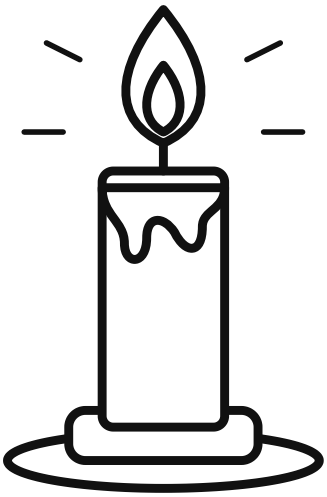
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ro' as in "road", short, with a light tap

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ら り る れ ろ

Katakana twin: □



ろ IS FOR

ろうそく

roosoku

candle

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ろ ろ ろ ろ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

わ

NAME · なまえ

わ

wa

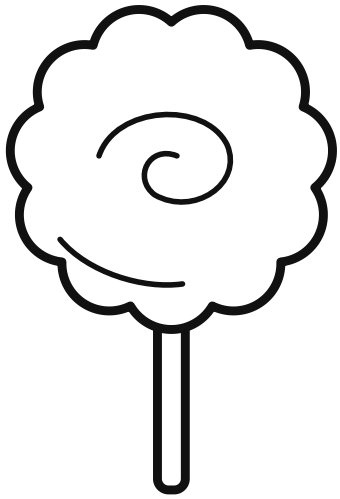
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘wa’ as in “wasp”

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

わ を

Katakana twin: ワ



わ IS FOR

わたあめ

wataame

cotton candy

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

わ わ わ わ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

を

NAME · なまえ

を

o

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’, just like お

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

わ [を]

Katakana twin: ヲ

を is only used as a little word after the thing you act on: ほんを よむ, “read a book”.



を IS FOR

ほんを よむ

hon o yomu

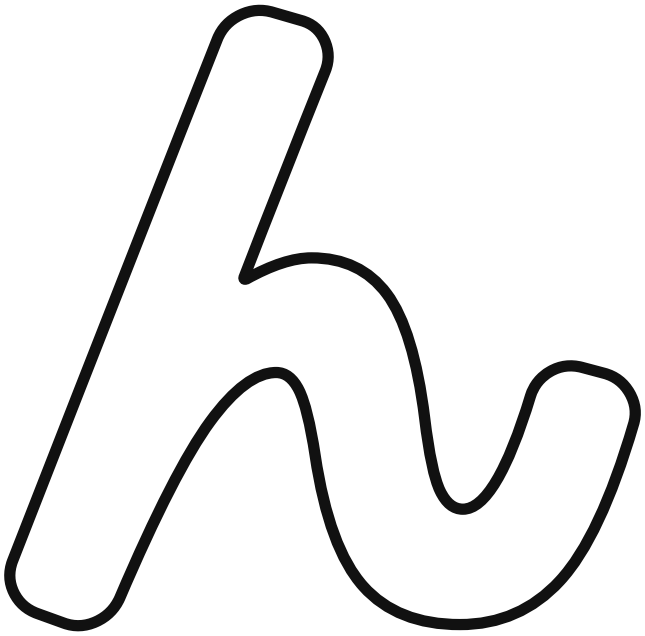
read a book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

を を を を

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



NAME · なまえ

ん

n

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

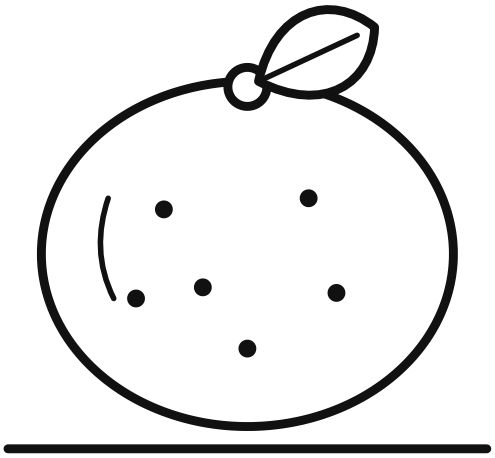
a humming ‘n’ that takes a whole beat

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ん

Katakana twin: ン

ん never starts a word. Find it at the end of みかん!



ん IS FOR

みかん

mikan

mandarin orange

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

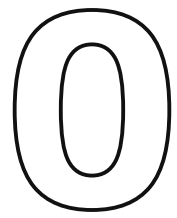
ん ん ん ん

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

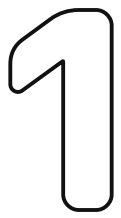
BONUS

Japanese numbers かず *(kazu)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Japanese: *zero*, *ichi*, *ni*, *san*...



0
ゼロ
zero
zero



1
一・いち
ichi
one



2
二・に
ni
two



3
三・さん
san
three



4
四・よん
yon
four



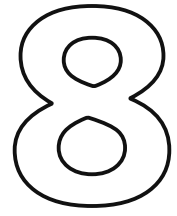
5
五・ご
go
five



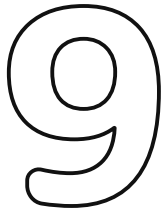
6
六・ろく
roku
six



7
七・なな
nana
seven



8
八・はち
hachi
eight



9
九・きゅう
kyuu
nine

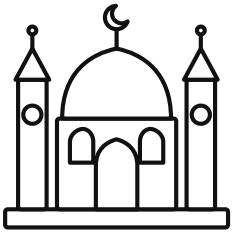
This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

LET'S TALK

My first Japanese words はじめての ことば

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

アッサラーム・アライクム	*assalaamu alaikum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
ワ・アライクム・アッサラーム	*wa alaikum assalaam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
こんにちは	*konnichiwa* **Hello!**
わたしの なまえは … です	*watashi no namae wa ... desu* **My name is ...**
ありがとう	*arigatoo* **Thank you**
ジャザーカッラーフ・ハイラン	*jazaakallaahu khairan* **May Allah reward you with good**
おかあさん・おとうさん	*okaasan · otoosan* **Mother · Father**
おにいさん・おねえさん	*oniisan · oneesan* **Big brother · Big sister**
はい・いいえ	*hai · iie* **Yes · No**
にほんごを ならって います！	*nihongo o naratte imasu!* **I am learning Japanese!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

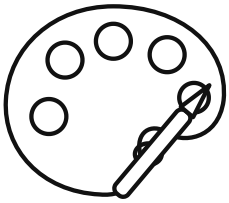
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International); the first-year kanji list from Japan's **Ministry of Education (MEXT)**.

What's next?
You have met all **46 Japanese letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Japanese, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

マーシャーアッラー！ よく できました！

maashaa-allaah! yoku dekimashita! — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 46 letters of the Japanese alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.